
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Middle Age T'ien Ch'i

Imperial Bureaucracy

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Unmodded 6.36 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Middle Age T'ien Ch'i: Imperial Bureaucracy

T'ien Ch'i one-page command brief

Middle Age T'ien Ch'i converts a large human roster, fortified cities, conscription, broad low-path magic, and four capital gems into flexible conventional armies and specialised ritual access. The official manual describes cavalry, heavy infantry, archers, crossbows, average priests, Order limited to +1, Misfortune limited to +1, and the ability of Eunuchs to conscript troops for province defence while collecting taxes. The nation is broad rather than automatically deep: most non-capital mages begin at one path and depend on randoms, combinations, gems, or capital recruitment for higher thresholds.

The opening should therefore preserve choices. Footmen and archers are cheap in gold, Ministry troops provide an intermediate line, Imperial troops consume more resources and recruitment points, and cavalry shifts more cost into gold. A Fortified City does not guarantee that every line can be produced efficiently; local resources, recruitment points, commander turns, and the need for laboratories still decide what a province can support.

The capital is unusually congested. Red Guards, Prince Generals, Imperial Alchemists, and Celestial Masters all compete for its recruitment capacity. The two capital sites also supply five gems per month in four paths, but income is not the same as access: a ritual still needs the correct caster, research, laboratory, gems, and a useful destination.

Treat random mages as recorded portfolios. The Inspector snapshot exposes the random masks, while the official manual confirms the visible base paths and costs. Recruit first, record the result, and only then assign a research, search, forge, ritual, priest, or battlefield role. Exact live display timing and any behaviour not printed by the sources remain unresolved.

T'ien Ch'i evidence and ruleset boundary

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age T'ien Ch'i under the Dominions 6.36 baseline. The official manual supplies the nation summary, roster, costs, recruitment locations, visible magic, site income, national spells, and item descriptions. The Dominions 6 Data Inspector snapshot at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`, pinned to the 6.35 data update, supplies object identifiers, random masks, hidden restriction fields, and cross-checks.

The two sources have different jobs. A structured row can establish that a random draw exists and which paths it contains, but it does not prove how the current client reveals that draw or how the resulting mage behaves in a real battle. The 6.36 patch ledger is checked for named changes after the pinned snapshot. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset is used here.

T'ien Ch'i conversion chain

```
cheap human roster and fortified cities
-> borders, taxes, and recruitment centres
-> recorded random-mage portfolio
-> research plus four-path capital gem income
-> national summons, alchemy, forging, and battlefield support
-> local armies, reserves, siege, and claims
```

The fragile arrows are infrastructure and depth. A wide roster can spend resources without creating the needed battlefield answer. A wide path portfolio can also look stronger on paper than it is if the required two-path or level-two result is rare. Plans should be attached to actual recruits and treasury balances, not to the union of every possible random.

T'ien Ch'i national rules that shape planning

Rule	Source-backed fact	Planning consequence
Fortified Cities	The manual lists Fortified Cities as the national building type.	Fort cost and build time still compete with laboratories, temples, troops, and commanders.
Conscription	Eunuchs conscript troops for province defence while collecting taxes.	Tax collection has a national side benefit, but the manual does not print exact composition or scaling.
Scales limits	Order is limited to +1 and Misfortune to +1.	Pretender design must respect both bounds instead of importing a generic human-nation scale plan.
Broad magic	The nation summary lists Water, Astral, Fire, Air, Earth, Nature, and Glamour.	The list describes the national portfolio, not guaranteed depth on each recruit.
Capital sacred	Red Guards are sacred and capital-only.	Bless investment serves a narrow recruitable troop queue unless it has other jobs.

The exact province-defence units and conscription rate are not stated in the manual table. Those details remain open rather than being inferred from an opaque attribute code.

T'ien Ch'i capital sites and recruitment geography

The Heavenly Gate produces one Air gem and two Astral pearls per month and enables Celestial Master recruitment. The Celestial City produces one Water and one Earth gem per month and enables Red Guards, Prince Generals, and Imperial Alchemists. Together they provide five capital gems per month: A1, W1, E1, and S2.

Master of the Way is the geographical exception among ordinary commanders: the manual marks it recruitable outside forts as well as in forts. That improves access to W1H1 and its five-path random without adding another fort, but gold, local recruitment rules, and safe movement still matter. All other capital-only records remain confined to the capital unless a source explicitly says otherwise.

T'ien Ch'i complete commander membership

The official roster contains eleven ordinary commander records and three capital-only records.

Recruitment	Commander records
Ordinary	Scout; Imperial Consort; Eunuch; General; Ceremonial Master; Minister of Rituals; Apothecary; Imperial Geomancer; Minister of Magic; Alchemist of the Five Elements; Master of the Way
Capital only	Prince General; Imperial Alchemist; Celestial Master

This is a membership table, not a recommendation. Scout and Eunuch jobs differ from combat command; priests differ in holy level; and several mage names hide materially different fixed and random paths.

T'ien Ch'i complete troop membership

The official roster contains fifteen ordinary troop records and one capital-only record.

Recruitment	Troop records
Ordinary	Footman with pike; Footman with glaive; Footman with spear and shield; Archer; Ministry Guardsman with glaive; Ministry Footman with spear and shield; Ministry Guardsman with man catcher; Imperial Footman; Imperial Archer; Imperial Crossbowman; Imperial City Guard; Imperial Guard; Horseman; Heavy Horseman; Imperial Horseman
Capital only	Red Guard

Weapon, shield, armour, morale, resource, and recruitment-point differences prevent these records from collapsing into one generic infantry or cavalry line. The right purchase depends on the reported enemy and the local production constraint.

T'ien Ch'i roster by job

Job	Main records	Boundary
Scouting	Scout	Information depends on survival and coverage.
Tax and provincial administration	Eunuch	Conscription is confirmed; exact output is unresolved.
Mundane command	General; Prince General	The Prince General consumes a capital turn and is not a default upgrade.
Priesthood	Ceremonial Master H1; Minister of Rituals H2; Master of the Way H1; Celestial Master H2	Holy level does not supply missing magical paths.
Cheap path specialists	Apothecary N1; Imperial Geomancer E1S1	Low cost and guaranteed paths make roles reproducible.
Random generalists	Minister of Magic; Alchemist of the Five Elements; Master of the Way	Final paths must be recorded before assignment.
Capital depth	Imperial Alchemist; Celestial Master	Stronger access competes with every other capital recruit.
Conventional line	Footmen, Ministry troops, Imperial troops	Gold, resources, recruitment points, shields, and weapons differ.
Mobile line	Horseman; Heavy Horseman; Imperial Horseman	Map movement and battlefield performance remain contextual.
Capital sacred	Red Guard	Capital-only, sacred, and expensive in gold relative to ordinary infantry.

T'ien Ch'i guaranteed mage and priest floor

The repeatable non-capital floor is N1 from Apothecaries, E1S1 from Imperial Geomancers, H2 from Ministers of Rituals, and W1H1 from Masters of the Way before their random. Ministers of Magic have no fixed magical path but receive one guaranteed four-path draw. Alchemists of the Five Elements begin at N1 and receive one guaranteed elemental draw.

This floor matters more than the theoretical ceiling. Celestial Servant is guaranteed on an Imperial Geomancer, and Thousand Year Ginseng is guaranteed on an N1 recruit once researched and funded. Many other national spells require a capital mage or a rare two-path result.

Master of the Way random portfolio

A Master of the Way has W1H1 and one guaranteed draw from Air, Water, Astral, Nature, or Glamour. Each result is one fifth of the portfolio: A1W1H1, W2H1, W1S1H1, W1N1H1, or W1G1H1.

This makes W2 repeatable in probability but not guaranteed on a particular purchase. It also spreads useful search and support roles across one recruitment record. Recruitment plans should use the 20% branches as expected distributions over many recruits, never as a promise for the next mage.

Minister of Magic random portfolio

A Minister of Magic receives one guaranteed draw from Air, Water, Earth, or Astral, followed by an independent 10% draw from the same four paths. The first draw gives each path a 25% share. Across both rolls, a particular path appears with probability 26.875%; a doubled result in one path occurs in 2.5% of all Ministers, and two distinct level-one paths occur in 7.5%.

Those aggregate numbers distinguish common single-path researchers from rare cross-path or level-two results. The individual named combination must still be recorded. A strategy that needs W1E1, for example, cannot budget every Minister as though the 1% unordered W/E result were already present.

Alchemist of the Five Elements random portfolio

An Alchemist of the Five Elements begins at N1, receives one guaranteed draw from Fire, Air, Water, or Earth, and then has an independent 10% draw from Fire, Air, Water, Earth, or Nature. Each elemental path is the first result 25% of the time and appears somewhere in the two rolls 26.5% of the time. The secondary Nature result raises the mage to N2 in 2% of recruits.

The guaranteed elemental draw is the reliable feature; the second draw is a portfolio bonus. Two-path elemental thresholds, double elemental levels, and N2 should be assigned only after the recruit exists.

Imperial Alchemist capital portfolio

An Imperial Alchemist begins at F1A1W1E1N2, then uses the same guaranteed elemental draw and independent 10% five-element draw as the ordinary Alchemist. This guarantees one elemental path at level two. A second roll can produce another elemental increase or N3, but none should be scheduled before recruitment reveals the result.

The base form already guarantees N2 rituals and W1E1 Living Mercury from the capital. Its breadth is powerful on paper, but each purchase also consumes four commander recruitment points and a capital turn that could have produced a Celestial Master, Prince General, or sacred troop capacity.

Celestial Master capital portfolio

A Celestial Master begins at A1W2E1S1G1H2, receives one guaranteed draw from Air, Water, Astral, Nature, or Glamour, and has an independent 10% draw from the same pool. The fixed paths guarantee Internal Alchemy and the A1S1 threshold for Celestial Hounds. A random Air increase reaches A2 for Call Celestial Soldiers; across the two rolls, at least one Air increase occurs in 21.6% of recruits.

This record combines priesthood, high recruitment cost, four commander recruitment points, cross-path magic, and rare depth. It should be bought for a named portfolio need, not merely because it has the broadest row.

T'ien Ch'i native path boundary

The national roster natively touches all seven paths named by the manual, but access is uneven.

Access class	Reliable examples	Important limitation
Guaranteed outside the capital	N1; E1S1; W1H1; H2	Mostly low-path access.
Random outside the capital	A, W, E, S, N, G; rare doubled or cross-path results	A possible result is not an owned caster.
Guaranteed in the capital	F1A1W1E1N2; A1W2E1S1G1H2	Capital queue and recruitment-point pressure.
Rare capital depth	Random increases on Imperial Alchemist and Celestial Master	Exact result must be observed after recruitment.
Hero-only additions	Death and higher Astral on named heroes	Hero arrival is not a repeatable schedule.

Death is not part of the repeatable recruitable mage floor shown in the roster. A hero record does not convert it into dependable national access.

T'ien Ch'i national spell and ritual reconciliation

The pinned restriction records contain ten T'ien Ch'i spells: one battle spell and nine rituals.

Spell	School and level	Path	Printed cost or type
Celestial Chastisement	Evocation 5	S3	Battle spell, 20 fatigue
Celestial Servant	Conjuration 1	E1S1	1 Earth gem
Ambush of Tigers	Conjuration 3	N2	9 Nature gems
Herd of Buffaloes	Conjuration 3	N2	8 Nature gems
Celestial Hounds	Conjuration 4	A1S1	2 Air gems
Thousand Year Ginseng	Construction 4	N1	4 Nature gems
Internal Alchemy	Alteration 5	W2S1	5 Water gems
Living Mercury	Enchantment 5	W1E1	6 Water gems
Contact Huli Jing	Conjuration 6	N2	30 Nature gems
Call Celestial Soldiers	Conjuration 6	A2S1	15 Air gems

Names, schools, levels, requirements, and costs are source facts. Exact variable summon counts, battlefield targeting, friendly-fire behaviour, shape changes, and practical combat value remain observation questions unless the manual explicitly prints them.

T'ien Ch'i ritual access from repeatable mages

Ritual	Access from roster	Scheduling boundary
Celestial Servant	Guaranteed Imperial Geomancer E1S1	Earliest national ritual; still costs a mage-turn and Earth gem.

Ritual	Access from roster	Scheduling boundary
Thousand Year Ginseng	Guaranteed N1 recruit	Does not itself create every later Nature threshold.
Ambush of Tigers; Herd of Buffaloes; Contact Huli Jing	Guaranteed Imperial Alchemist N2; 2% N2 ordinary Alchemist	Capital access is reliable; non-capital access is rare.
Internal Alchemy	Guaranteed Celestial Master W2S1	Capital-only guaranteed caster.
Celestial Hounds	Guaranteed Celestial Master A1S1; rare A/S Minister	Ordinary two-path access is an uncommon result.
Living Mercury	Guaranteed Imperial Alchemist W1E1; rare W/E ordinary random	Capital access is reliable.
Call Celestial Soldiers	Celestial Master needs an Air increase to reach A2S1	At least one Air random occurs on 21.6% of Celestial Masters.
Celestial Chastisement	Needs S3	No ordinary recruit guarantees S3; capital randoms, boosters, or other bridges are needed.

This table separates national availability from legal casting. Researching a national spell before its caster and treasury exist can create no deployable package.

T'ien Ch'i capital gem economy

The capital produces A1, W1, E1, and S2 each month. That income supports several national paths but produces no Nature gems, even though four national rituals use Nature. Site searching, trade, events, Pretender design, or other documented income must therefore supply the Nature treasury; national restriction alone does not fund it.

Separate ledgers should be kept for Air, Water, Earth, Astral, and Nature. The first three pay for national rituals directly, Astral supports other national magic and infrastructure, and Nature has a structural mismatch between ritual demand and starting site income.

T'ien Ch'i national item boundary

Four items have explicit T'ien Ch'i links in the pinned data and manual descriptions.

Item	National relation	Requirement
Sword of the Five Elements	Restricted national item	Construction 3, F1W1
Armor of the Five Elements	Restricted national item	Construction 3, E1A1
Chi Shoes	National rebate	Construction 3, A1
Jade Armor	National rebate	Construction 7, W2E1

The manual prints two Fire and two Water gems for the Sword, and two Earth and two Air gems for the Armor. The rebate fields establish that Chi Shoes and Jade Armor are discounted for T'ien Ch'i, but the final displayed live cost and interaction with other forge modifiers remain unresolved here.

T'ien Ch'i hero records

The pinned nation records name three heroes: Ho Hsien-Ku, Lu Tung-Pin, and Li T'ieh-Kuai. Their corresponding forms provide A1N2; F1A1W2S3H2; and A2S2D2 respectively, with the first two marked sacred in the structured snapshot.

These records document possible capabilities, including hero-only Death and direct S3. They do not make those paths repeatable. Arrival timing, event conditions, alternate forms, and live behaviour remain unresolved unless an official source or versioned observation establishes them.

T'ien Ch'i patch reconciliation

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026. The local official patch ledger was searched through its 6.35 endpoint, and the separate official 6.36 announcement was checked; neither supplies a direct Middle Age T'ien Ch'i or named-roster correction for this chapter. This negative search is not proof that no indirect engine change matters; it means only that no nation-specific correction can safely be attached from the available named notes.

The structured object snapshot remains pinned to 6.35, so the manual and official 6.36 ledger take precedence where they conflict. Any later discrepancy should be recorded as a new source-reconciliation issue rather than silently normalised.

T'ien Ch'i opening priorities

- 1 Identify whether each fort site is limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns.
- 2 Use the cheapest troop line that answers the observed independent province instead of defaulting to Imperial equipment.
- 3 Add scouting and mundane leadership without spending mage turns on jobs a General or Scout can perform.
- 4 Record every random mage's final paths before assigning research, search, forge, ritual, or combat duty.
- 5 Protect the capital queue for the specific Red Guard, Prince General, Imperial Alchemist, or Celestial Master requirement that the plan names.
- 6 Track Nature demand separately because the capital sites supply no Nature gems.

These are planning controls, not tested expansion prescriptions. Exact party sizes, formations, scripts, and casualty expectations remain open.

T'ien Ch'i recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

Cheap foot and missile package

Footmen and Archers preserve gold for forts and mages, but their weapons, armour, shields, and morale differ. The package should be selected against the reported province rather than treated as one undifferentiated mass.

Ministry middle line

Ministry Guardsmen and Footmen trade more gold, resources, and recruitment points for stronger equipment and morale. Glaives, spear-and-shield, and man catchers have different target profiles; none is a universal upgrade.

Imperial protected line

Imperial Footmen, City Guards, Guards, Archers, and Crossbowmen offer heavier profiles at greater production cost. The right mixture depends on local resources, enemy armour and shields, missile conditions, and whether the fort must also produce cavalry.

Cavalry response group

Horsemen, Heavy Horsemen, and Imperial Horsemen offer three price and equipment tiers. Map speed does not by itself establish expansion safety or battlefield value, so route, fatigue, formation, and target selection remain report-dependent.

Capital Red Guard reserve

Red Guards are sacred, capital-only, and cost fifty gold. A bless and capital allocation should solve a defined problem before the nation pays that opportunity cost.

T'ien Ch'i research response tree

Branch A: guaranteed low-path utility

Construction 4 reaches Thousand Year Ginseng for N1, while Conjuraction 1 reaches Celestial Servant for E1S1. This branch uses guaranteed non-capital paths, but its value still depends on gems, mage-turns, and what the summoned or transformed asset contributes.

Branch B: capital cross-path rituals

Alteration 5 Internal Alchemy, Enchantment 5 Living Mercury, and Conjuraction 4 Celestial Hounds align with guaranteed capital mage paths. The capital must recruit those casters before the research becomes an operational package.

Branch C: Nature summons

Conjuraction 3 opens Ambush of Tigers and Herd of Buffaloes; Conjuraction 6 opens Contact Huli Jing. Imperial Alchemists guarantee N2, but the capital provides no Nature income. Research and treasury therefore have to be planned together.

Branch D: higher Air and Astral thresholds

Conjuraction 6 Call Celestial Soldiers requires A2S1, normally a Celestial Master with an Air increase. Evocation 5 Celestial Chastisement requires S3 and is not guaranteed on ordinary recruits. This branch should wait for an actual caster or a documented bridge.

T'ien Ch'i battlefield packages

Conventional line with separate command

A General leads the selected infantry or cavalry while mages preserve their actions for spells. This separation is useful only if the army has enough mundane leadership and the chosen line answers the enemy's protection, weapons, mobility, and numbers.

Mixed missile and protected line

Archers or crossbowmen operate behind a shielded or armoured line. Range, weather, friendly obstruction, enemy shields, armour, and closing speed determine value; the source tables cannot settle those battlefield outcomes.

Broad-mage support group

Recorded Ministers, Alchemists, Geomancers, and Masters of the Way are selected for actual paths rather than names. This prevents a nominally broad squad from arriving without the cross-path or depth the script assumes.

Capital ritual-supported force

Imperial Alchemists or Celestial Masters turn researched national rituals into assets. The full package must include the capital recruitment turn, research, gem source, ritual turn, commander, and route to the front.

T'ien Ch'i Pretender families

Family	What it can solve	What it must not conceal
Economy and infrastructure	Funds forts, laboratories, commanders, and a large conventional roster	Gold does not create local resources or extra capital queue capacity.
Nature-income bridge	Supports the national Nature ritual suite	A path without site income, search, trade, or gems is not a treasury.
High-path bridge	Supplies reliable S3, deeper Air, or another missing threshold	Native random access should be counted before paying twice for it.
Sacred design	Supports Red Guards and sacred commanders or summons	Most ordinary troops are not sacred.
Awake expander	Supplies early province-taking while human infrastructure develops	Afflictions, counters, scales, and opportunity cost remain map-dependent.

No exact design is endorsed without settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and a versioned test or game record.

T'ien Ch'i matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Massed light units	Footprint, missiles, cavalry, protected lines, and reachable area effects	Buying the most expensive Imperial record by default.
Heavy armour	Crossbows, high-damage weapons, buffs, fatigue, and armour-answering magic	Assuming every glaive or spell solves every protection value.
Fast flankers or flyers	Guards, reserves, mage spacing, and local response forces	Exposing rare random or capital mages in one rear cluster.
High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets	Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, and control	Treating broad national magic as proof that the required caster exists.
High Magic Resistance or mindless units	Conventional pressure, buffs, summons, and non-MR effects	Building the battle around a single Astral resistance check.
Raiding and dispersed pressure	Scouts, fortified cities, Eunuchs, local troops, and reserve commanders	Concentrating every useful recruit in the capital.
Gem denial	Guaranteed low-path tools and mundane roster depth	Researching a ritual tree that the treasury cannot fund.

Monthly T'ien Ch'i audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Is every random mage labelled by final paths and assigned a role that uses them?
- Are mundane commanders available where using a mage would lose research or ritual tempo?
- Is the capital queue reserved for a named Red Guard, Prince General, Imperial Alchemist, or Celestial Master job?
- Are Air, Water, Earth, Astral, and Nature balances tracked separately?
- Does each national ritual have research, a legal caster, gems, a mage-turn, and a delivery plan?
- Is conscription being treated as confirmed without inventing its exact composition or scaling?
- Does the troop mix answer the reported armour, weapons, missiles, mobility, and morale?
- Are hero paths excluded from schedules that must be repeatable?
- Has any 6.35 structured field been checked against the 6.36 manual and patch ledger before publication?

T'ien Ch'i unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, and casualty ranges for every infantry, missile, cavalry, and Red Guard package;
- 2 exact Eunuch conscription composition, growth rate, interaction with province defence, and live display;
- 3 live 6.36 presentation and timing of every random-magic result;
- 4 summon counts or composition where the manual does not print a fixed result;
- 5 Celestial Chastisement targeting, resistance, friendly-fire risk, and battlefield value;
- 6 Internal Alchemy transformation details and persistence beyond the printed ritual description;
- 7 Living Mercury, Celestial Hound, Celestial Soldier, Huli Jing, tiger, buffalo, and Celestial Servant scripting and combat behaviour;
- 8 final displayed rebate costs for Chi Shoes and Jade Armor under combined forge modifiers;
- 9 hero arrival timing, alternate forms, and live behaviour;
- 10 specific Pretender designs, blesses, matchups, and map performance.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: MA Marignon, MA Pyrène, MA Ulm, MA Man, MA Abysia, MA Pythium, MA Eriu, MA Agarth, MA Uruk, MA Ashdod, and MA T'ien Ch'i nation pages; national spells and rituals; research; communions, Chorus, and Grand Communion; Blood and crossbreeding; Inquisition; mounts; forging; and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.36, including the current Send Aatxe restriction, communion corrections, the 6.13 Forest of Avalon Magic correction, the 6.01 Abysia wall-defender note, Eriu's 6.01 terrain-recruit and Bean Sidhe corrections, and Agarth's 6.04 Oracle-shape note. The only Pythium name match applies explicitly to Late Age Pythium. Nation-specific changes are attached only where the record names the affected object.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks, recruitment records, capital sites, national spell restrictions, national item fields, and current object cross-checks.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, site income, item restrictions, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, crossbreeding outputs, displayed forge-cost stacking, communion and Grand Communion outcomes, hydra-field behaviour, Spell Singer outcomes, Glamour detection, special-dominion scaling and targeting, ancestor-summon behaviour, conscription output, spell targeting, and combat outcomes remain observation questions until a versioned raw set is published.